

Make a useful lender introduction and follow through

71 minutes including practice · 28 screens

Edition 2026-09-16-day4-quadrants-v2

Before you begin

Eric opens Rep, selects the training and existing agents across teams, confirms the timezone, and creates the session. The creator is the default presenter and follow-up coach. Keep the presenter console on your screen and share the separate presentation window from the same browser. Click an answer on your presenter slide to highlight it in both windows. Ask for the reasoning, then click Submit answer to share the explanation. Open Presenter notes in the toolbar for the current slide; those notes stay private. People without HQ can answer aloud and explain their choice; this discussion selection does not create an individual submission.

Ask each selected agent to open the session through their own existing login. No second invitation is needed. Confirm that everyone can join and see the current activity. Submit written work before showing the model. Give one correction, then ask for a targeted retry. Advance to the question. Agents answer and submit on that slide, and their answers appear automatically beside your slide. Review actual arrivals before revealing the example. If someone needs more time, pause or return to the slide.

In self-paced study, notes remain in the learner's browser until they choose to share them. In a live session, the presenter sees submitted answers and progress; unsubmitted writing stays private. Preserve first attempts; a retry after an example is assisted.

For remote practice, use the meeting platform's breakout rooms. Assign pairs or trios and rotate agent, buyer, and observer. In pairs, the buyer gives feedback. Every agent needs a speaking turn, one correction, and a retry. If a partner is absent, assign a coach or leave the observation outstanding.

What each signal means

Connection status is separate from participation. A submitted answer is separate from a completed action. A record check is separate from writing quality. Record who observed a speaking turn and who reviewed it; a peer observation or self-check is not coach sign-off. Practice readiness, quiz certification, and activation remain separate.

Facilitator flow

01 / 28 · 0-1 min · Welcome

Help buyers prepare for a lender conversation

Use the visible explanation as the teaching reference. Ask what the agent would do, hear the reason, then demonstrate the steps. Fictional examples illustrate the existing TRU process. Sources: existing day curriculum; Eric's September 16 quadrant and independent-review requirements. Handoff: Next: What you will learn and practice. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: What you will learn and practice. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

What you will learn and practice

Use the visible explanation as the teaching reference. Ask what the agent would do, hear the reason, then demonstrate the steps. Fictional examples illustrate the existing TRU process. Sources: existing day curriculum; Eric's September 16 quadrant and independent-review requirements. Handoff: Next: Recognize when lender help would be useful. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Recognize when lender help would be useful. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

03 / 28 · 2-2 min · 1. Recognize when lender help would be useful

Recognize when lender help would be useful

Use the visible explanation as the teaching reference. Ask what the agent would do, hear the reason, then demonstrate the steps. Fictional examples illustrate the existing TRU process. Sources: existing day curriculum; Eric's September 16 quadrant and independent-review requirements. Handoff: Next: Jordan wants to make an offer. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Jordan wants to make an offer. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

04 / 28 · 2-5 min · 1. Recognize when lender help would be useful

Jordan wants to make an offer

Have every agent submit an individual response before revealing the model. Compare the main pattern in the room, then demonstrate once. The choice is a warm-up, not proof of skill; the next activity is an observed attempt. Handoff: Next: Connect the lender conversation to a specific need. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Connect the lender conversation to a specific need. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: Jordan wants to offer but has not sent documents to the bank. What next?

- Promise approval today.
- Clarify what the bank confirmed and offer help.
- List every product benefit.
- Write your introduction.
- Write your permission question.
- What is the next action if the buyer accepts?

After submission: Clarify what the bank confirmed and offer help. Clarify the buyer's actual need before offering a relevant option. Explain one supported benefit, preserve lender choice, and confirm the next action only after consent. An introduction is optional; approval and savings cannot be promised.

Reveal after the first response:

Jordan, you want to be ready to offer, and we still need to confirm the financing. I work with a loan officer at Zillow Home Loans who can help you understand your options and next steps. Would an introduction be useful? You're free to choose the lender that works best for you. [If accepted:] Is a call this afternoon a useful next step?

Connect the lender conversation to a specific need

Use the visible explanation as the teaching reference. Ask what the agent would do, hear the reason, then demonstrate the steps. Fictional examples illustrate the existing TRU process. Sources: existing day curriculum; Eric's September 16 quadrant and independent-review requirements. Handoff: Next: What Zillow Home Loans offers your buyer. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: What Zillow Home Loans offers your buyer. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

What Zillow Home Loans offers your buyer

Keep the ecosystem explanation to one minute. Ask: which of these benefits matters to Jordan right now? Accept a buyer-specific answer. Remove the implication that software removes all friction or that a particular letter automatically wins an offer. A named loan officer and a clear next action are the practical value. Handoff: Next: Know what to explain and what the lender must confirm. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Know what to explain and what the lender must confirm. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Know what to explain and what the lender must confirm

Use the visible explanation as the teaching reference. Ask what the agent would do, hear the reason, then demonstrate the steps. Fictional examples illustrate the existing TRU process. Sources: existing day curriculum; Eric's September 16 quadrant and independent-review requirements. Handoff: Next: What would you clarify about the buyer's financing?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: What would you clarify about the buyer's financing?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

What would you clarify about the buyer's financing?

Present the situation without giving the answer. Allow a quiet first response, then hear two different approaches. Recognize sound reasoning and identify gaps before moving to the teaching slides. This discussion is ungraded. Sources: Eric's September 16 teaching format; existing TRU curriculum. Handoff: Next: Pre-qualification, pre-approval, and final approval. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Pre-qualification, pre-approval, and final approval. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: A buyer says, "My bank gave me a letter, so I'm ready to offer tonight."

- What would you do, and why? What information would change your answer?

Reveal after the first response:

Ask what the lender has reviewed, what is still conditional, whether the property affects the review, and what timing the file can support. Let the loan officer confirm the process for this buyer. Avoid promising approval, credit impact or a closing date.

Coach-led discussion. No automatic grade. Ask learners to explain their reasoning and what information would change their recommendation.

Pre-qualification, pre-approval, and final approval

Ask agents to explain the stages without reading them. Correct the idea that a branded letter is a guarantee. Do not claim that all other lenders use unverified information. Fully underwritten pre-approval is another level of review to discuss with the loan officer. Ask: what would you want to know before relying on any letter? Handoff: Next: Questions for the loan officer. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Questions for the loan officer. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Questions for the loan officer

The source deck's 585 floor conflicts with the current FAQ, which states 620 for most loan types. Do not replace one blanket cutoff with another in agent scripts. Route eligibility to the lender. The FAQ contains inconsistent wording about hard checks, but explicitly allows circumstances requiring a hard inquiry. Do not use "soft pull always." Keep product exclusions, exact terms, fee claims and special pricing in the reference review, not memory drills. Handoff: Next: How would you explain the credit check?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: How would you explain the credit check?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

How would you explain the credit check?

Pause before clicking. Ask agents to rewrite one of the wrong answers in their own voice. Take two answers. Move on once they can state a benefit without a promise. If most miss it, return to the preceding slide for a 30-second clarification. Handoff: Next: Offer an introduction and understand concerns. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Offer an introduction and understand concerns. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: Choose the sentence you would use with a real buyer.

- "Zillow never needs a hard credit pull."
- "Pre-qualification uses a soft check. Let's ask the loan officer what happens after that."
- "Once you have the letter, financing is guaranteed."

After submission: "Pre-qualification uses a soft check. Let's ask the loan officer what happens after that." Correct. Explain the initial step, then let the loan officer confirm what this buyer's process requires.

Offer an introduction and understand concerns

Use the visible explanation as the teaching reference. Ask what the agent would do, hear the reason, then demonstrate the steps. Fictional examples illustrate the existing TRU process. Sources: existing day curriculum; Eric's September 16 quadrant and independent-review requirements. Handoff: Next: What would you ask when the buyer already has a lender?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: What would you ask when the buyer already has a lender?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

What would you ask when the buyer already has a lender?

Present the situation without giving the answer. Allow a quiet first response, then hear two different approaches. Recognize sound reasoning and identify gaps before moving to the teaching slides. This discussion is ungraded. Sources: Eric's September 16 teaching format; existing TRU curriculum. Handoff: Next: Responding to common concerns. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Responding to common concerns. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: The buyer says, "My bank has handled everything for years. Why would I need another conversation?"

- What would you do, and why? What information would change your answer?

Reveal after the first response:

Acknowledge the existing relationship. Ask whether anything remains unclear. Offer a second conversation only if it would help. Identify Zillow Home Loans clearly, ask permission and respect a decline.

Coach-led discussion. No automatic grade. Ask learners to explain their reasoning and what information would change their recommendation.

Responding to common concerns

Have an agent answer before revealing each coaching example. Ask the buyer role: did that address your actual concern? If not, ask a question instead of pushing harder. Cover all three briefly. On comparison shopping, do not promise to beat a rate or say a comparison is automatically free of credit impact. Have each agent submit one response. Reveal one relevant example, then ask them to retry a specific phrase. Do not measure success by whether the buyer accepts an introduction. Handoff: Next: How to introduce your loan officer. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: How to introduce your loan officer. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: Choose one buyer concern. Respond in a way that helps them decide.

- Which concern are you responding to, and what would you say?

Reveal after the first response:

Already has a lender: "What do you like about working with them, and is there anything you still want clarity on?" If useful, offer an optional second perspective without promising savings. Credit concern: "Is your concern about the first step, or about what happens later in the application?" Let the loan officer explain the process; do not promise every step is free of credit impact. Required lender: "You choose your lender. My role is to help you understand your options. An introduction is available if you want it." If they decline, respect it and discuss the next step with their chosen lender.

How to introduce your loan officer

Use the visible example to explain each part before the practice. Ask agents which question would help this buyer. Preserve their choice. Handoff: Next: Explain the reason before asking for an introduction. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Explain the reason before asking for an introduction. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Explain the reason before asking for an introduction

Use the visible explanation as the teaching reference. Ask what the agent would do, hear the reason, then demonstrate the steps. Fictional examples illustrate the existing TRU process. Sources: existing day curriculum; Eric's September 16 quadrant and independent-review requirements. Handoff: Next: Practice your introduction. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Practice your introduction. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Practice your introduction

The framework and example now come before this practice. Give each agent a speaking turn, specific feedback and a targeted retry. Do not label a peer or self-check as coach sign-off. Respect a declined introduction. Handoff: Next: Complete the handoff and follow through. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Complete the handoff and follow through. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: Use Jordan's situation. Keep it under a minute.

- What one correction will you retry?
- What changed in your retry?

Observer criteria:

- Reflects the buyer's actual concern
- Explains one relevant supported benefit
- Asks genuine permission and preserves buyer choice
- Names an appropriate next action and owner; confirms after consent

Complete the handoff and follow through

Use the visible explanation as the teaching reference. Ask what the agent would do, hear the reason, then demonstrate the steps. Fictional examples illustrate the existing TRU process. Sources: existing day curriculum; Eric's September 16 quadrant and independent-review requirements. Handoff: Next: What would you do after an unanswered introduction?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: What would you do after an unanswered introduction?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

What would you do after an unanswered introduction?

Present the situation without giving the answer. Allow a quiet first response, then hear two different approaches. Recognize sound reasoning and identify gaps before moving to the teaching slides. This discussion is ungraded. Sources: Eric's September 16 teaching format; existing TRU curriculum. Handoff: Next: Make the introduction and confirm the call. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Make the introduction and confirm the call. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: The buyer agreed to an introduction. You sent it, but neither the buyer nor loan officer has confirmed a call.

- What would you do, and why? What information would change your answer?

Reveal after the first response:

Check that the loan officer received the introduction and confirm a workable contact time with both parties. Tell the buyer what to expect. Record permission, the next owner and the follow-up time. Sending a message alone does not confirm the handoff.

Coach-led discussion. No automatic grade. Ask learners to explain their reasoning and what information would change their recommendation.

20 / 28 · 43-46 min · 4. Complete the handoff and follow through

Make the introduction and confirm the call

Ask: if we send this and hear nothing, who owns the next move? The agent owns checking that the introduction landed, not promising a loan outcome. Do not put financial documents or sensitive account information into a group message. Use the approved lender channel for the application. Handoff: Next: Follow up on incomplete introductions. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Follow up on incomplete introductions. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

21 / 28 · 46-49 min · 4. Complete the handoff and follow through

Follow up on incomplete introductions

The original deck specifies 4% conversion, 25% pickup, 10% pre-approval, and a rolling 90-day window. Those exact thresholds, attribution rules, and lead consequences were not established by current public sources. Confirm them in the team's live dashboard with the program owner. Explain numerator and denominator using the example, without presenting it as a policy. Do not imply agents control approval decisions or should change statuses to improve a metric. Show the illustrative calculation briefly. Spend the discussion on stalled introductions, missing consent or owners, and the next useful action rather than testing arithmetic. Handoff: Next: Check financing before writing an offer. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Check financing before writing an offer. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

22 / 28 · 49-52 min · 4. Complete the handoff and follow through

Check financing before writing an offer

Give 30 seconds to answer before revealing. Invite one person to act as Jordan and another as the agent. Ask Jordan to repeat what happens next; if they cannot, the agent should clarify the handoff. Reinforce that a lender's average speed is not a promise for this transaction. Handoff: Next: Practice with a buyer and an observer. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Practice with a buyer and an observer. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: Return to Jordan. The buyer wants to write tonight.

- Your two-sentence update

Reveal after the first response:

"The loan officer is checking the details for this property and what is still needed. Let's confirm those items and a workable timeline before we rely on financing terms in the offer."

Practice with a buyer and an observer

Allow one minute for roles, three two-minute rounds, and a one-minute debrief. Give every agent a speaking turn, one specific correction, and a targeted retry. Use the meeting platform for breakout rooms. In pairs, the buyer supplies the observation; in trios, rotate agent, buyer, observer. Do not label a peer or self-check as coach sign-off. If no partner is present, assign a coach or leave the observation outstanding. Record what was observed without unsupported claims. A buyer declining an introduction does not fail the attempt; observe how the agent respects that choice. Handoff: Next: What do you remember?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: What do you remember?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: Trios: agent, buyer, observer. Switch roles each round.

- What specific correction will you retry?
- What changed in your retry?

Observer criteria:

- Reflects the buyer's actual concern
- Explains one relevant supported benefit
- Asks genuine permission and preserves buyer choice
- Names an appropriate next action and owner; confirms after consent

What do you remember?

Give 60 seconds with no help. Have partners compare from memory for 30 seconds. Reveal and ask them to fill a gap in a different color on paper, or revise their text. This revisits key ideas after a delay for retrieval, not another lecture. If a gap is common, ask for a fresh example instead of rereading. Handoff: Next: Explain the buyer's lender choice. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Explain the buyer's lender choice. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: Write first. Compare second. Fill the gaps.

- 1 · What are the four conversation steps?
- 2 · What does a pre-approval not guarantee?
- 3 · What makes a handoff complete?

Reveal after the first response:

Reflect -> Explain -> Ask -> Confirm. A pre-approval is conditional; it does not guarantee funding. A complete handoff includes permission, an identified loan officer, a confirmed next step and owner, and a follow-up time.

Explain the buyer's lender choice

Vote before selecting. Ask someone who chose correctly to explain why the other answers fall short. Finish with a 30-second individual spoken response. The multiple-choice answer is only a check; the spoken response demonstrates the skill. Use the four-behavior rubric if an agent needs another attempt. Handoff: Next: Plan your next practice. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Plan your next practice. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: Show that you can apply the lesson.

- “Yes, it’s part of our program.”
- “No, but they will definitely save you money.”
- “You choose your lender. If a second conversation would help, may I introduce you to a loan officer at Zillow Home Loans?”

After submission: “You choose your lender. If a second conversation would help, may I introduce you to a loan officer at Zillow Home Loans?” Yes. You respected the decision and offered a concrete, optional next step. Now confirm the contact method and time only if Jordan agrees.

26 / 28 · 66-69 min · 4. Complete the handoff and follow through

Plan your next practice

In live sessions, closing the session creates 24-hour recall, three-day fresh-case, and seven-day coach-review assignments. Confirm each agent’s named coach and session timezone. Agents see due work in Rep; the daily digest links to due or reviewable work. In self-paced study, arrange these checks with a coach. Without a relevant client opportunity, use a fresh fictional case and label real-work application not yet observed. Practice readiness is separate from quiz certification and activation. Handoff: Next: What to do after this training. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: What to do after this training. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: Choose a time to practice again without the slides.

- My next practice commitment

27 / 28 · 69-70 min · Review and reference

What to do after this training

Close on the behavior, not the team metric. Ask for one final takeaway in the buyer’s language. Keep the resource sheet available for questions. If an agent did not demonstrate all four behaviors, schedule another brief practice before marking the skill ready in your own coaching process. This workshop does not issue a certification. Handoff: Next: Use this training after the session. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Ask the room: Next: Use this training after the session. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

28 / 28 · 70-71 min · Review and reference

Use this training after the session

Use the visible explanation as the teaching reference. Ask what the agent would do, hear the reason, then demonstrate the steps. Fictional examples illustrate the existing TRU process. Sources: existing day curriculum; Eric’s September 16 quadrant and independent-review requirements. Handoff: Return to the relevant quadrant when you need the steps, then practice again.

Ask the room: Return to the relevant quadrant when you need the steps, then practice again.

Buyer practice cards

Jordan • offer tonight

I love the house, but I have not sent my bank any documents yet.

Clarify readiness and ask permission for a useful next step.

Morgan • already has a lender

My bank has handled everything for years. Why would I need another conversation?

Acknowledge the relationship. Explore whether a comparison would help.

Alex • credit concern

I want to understand the credit check before deciding.

Respect the concern. Let the loan officer explain the actual process.

After the workshop

Live session: closing the session creates assignments for recall within 24 hours, a fresh case in three days, and coach review in seven days. The session creator owns follow-up across the selected teams unless a different authorized coach was selected. Confirm the displayed session timezone. Due and overdue work appears in Rep; the daily digest links to work due or awaiting review.

Self-paced study: arrange those same checks with a coach. If there has been no relevant client opportunity, use a new fictional case and mark real-work application as not yet observed.

Keep the first attempt and correction. A useful follow-up asks whether the agent can apply the skill in another case.

References and certification

Updated September 16, 2026 from the existing Day 4 workshop and Eric's approved interactive-training plan. TRU sales doctrine remains the source for coaching the first call and follow-up.

- [Zillow Home Loans FAQ](#)
- [ZHL agent tools](#)
- [CFPB: comparing loan offers](#)

Day 4 is a practice workshop; it does not issue a certification.